charge was linked to Maharaja Duleep Singh's visit to Russia in 1888. Duleep Singh was the Maharaja of Punjab when the Treaty of Amritsar was signed, and he visited Russia to garner the support of the Russian Czar, Alexander II. In the same year, a Russian agent, Capt. Gromchevsky, accompanied by a six-man Cossack escort, entered Hunza where its ruler, Mir Safdar Ali, received him as a guest. Ali was a vassal to Maharaja Pratap Singh, which ultimately became the grounds for Maharaja Pratap Singh's suspension from his rule from 1889 to 1905.

First Instance of Central Rule in Kashmir

In February 1889, the British Resident, Col. Parry Nisbet, stripped Pratap Singh of his authority as the sovereign ruler for carrying out treasonable correspondence with the enemies of the British Empire.[17] Col. Nisbet was the first of many British Residents who ruled the state during this interregnum, assisted by a Council of Regency. Though this action violated both the Treaty of Amritsar and the Queen's Proclamation of 1858, there was no appeal made against it in any court of law because it was deemed an 'act of state' and was not subject to the jurisdiction of the courts. The heir to the throne, Raja Amar Singh, Pratap Singh's younger brother, was actively involved in the Council of Regency and exercised great influence in the state during this period. Many historians assert that Amar Singh was actually favoured by Maharaja Ranbir Singh to be his successor, but the law of primogeniture prevented this from happening.

In order to keep the Russians at bay, it suited the British to keep the state in governmental limbo, notwithstanding the 'independence' granted to it via the Treaty of Amritsar. Pratap Singh's diplomatic forays were quelled and, seven years later, in September 1896, the Pamir Boundary Commission protocols were signed, thereby defining the border between Afghanistan and Russia. The Wakhan Corridor which joined Gilgit to Russia was given to Afghanistan and the country now officially became a buffer between Russia and India. In this case, Kashmir was explicitly considered a part of India and its ruler had been dispossessed by the British.